

Morning Briefing — 25 May 2026

UK SPRING BANK HOLIDAY

US MEMORIAL DAY

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FTSE 100 CLOSED (Spring Bank Holiday) | NYSE / Nasdaq CLOSED (Memorial Day) | Continental European exchanges open — DAX, CAC 40, Euro Stoxx 50 trade in reduced-liquidity conditions today. Expect amplified intraday moves and wide bid/offer spreads.

2. IMPORTANT NEWS

Trump says US-Iran deal "largely negotiated" — Strait of Hormuz reopening expected within days

[CNN](#) / [CNBC](#) / [Bloomberg](#) / [NPR](#) — 23–24 May 2026

Single largest near-term market catalyst. Phase 1 targets Hormuz reopening; Phase 2 (30–60 days) covers nuclear provisions and war termination. Oil at \$98–105/bbl priced with a large geopolitical premium — formal announcement triggers rapid repricing. Iran's Fars agency disputes control terms; gap remains on sovereignty over the Strait.

Dow Jones closes at all-time record 50,580; S&P 500 marks eighth consecutive weekly gain at 7,473

[TheStreet](#) / [Motley Fool](#) / [Yahoo Finance](#) — 22 May 2026

US equity rally shows no signs of fatigue heading into the long weekend. Easing Treasury yields (10Y at 4.57%) and marginally lower oil supported the move. Sets a high bar for any disappointment when US markets reopen Tuesday 26 May.

Nokia +10.6%, ASML +5% as AI infrastructure demand re-rates European tech

[CNBC](#) — week of 22 May 2026

Nokia surged on strong order flow tied to AI network infrastructure buildout. ASML benefits from sustained semiconductor capex. European tech catching up to the US AI re-rating. Watch for consolidation or continuation in thin holiday market.

US CPI 3.8% vs 3.7% expected; core CPI 2.8% vs 2.6% forecast — Fed rate-cut path pushed further out

[MarketPulse](#) (OANDA) — May 2026

Sticky inflation keeps the Fed on hold. Dollar firmed in response (DXY ~99.3, 6-week high). EUR/USD rejected 1.18 resistance and is pressing toward 1.17 support. June FOMC meeting increasingly live as data continues to surprise to the upside.

STOXX Europe 600 +3.0% for the week — testing highest levels since before the Iran war outbreak

[T. Rowe Price](#) weekly update / [CNBC](#) — 22 May 2026

European equities in full geopolitical de-escalation re-rating. Banks, industrials (Schneider +2%+, Airbus +2%+), and financials (Santander, UniCredit +2%+) leading. Key technical test in progress. Further upside requires deal confirmation and earnings follow-through.

3. EUROPEAN FUTURES — PRE-OPEN

Continental exchanges open. UK closed (bank holiday). US closed (Memorial Day). Futures data from Investing.com pre-market session. Thin liquidity may widen the futures-to-spot gap.

INDEX	FUTURES LEVEL	FRI SPOT CLOSE	IMPLIED MOVE	STATUS
Euro Stoxx 50	5,907	6,019.45	-112 pts / ~-1.9%	Liquidity-thin caution
DAX	n/a	24,888.56	—	Open
CAC 40	n/a	8,115.75	—	Open
FTSE 100	CLOSED	10,466.26	—	Spring Bank Holiday

US FUTURES (CONTEXT ONLY)	LEVEL	NOTE
S&P 500 E-mini	Very limited	Memorial Day — electronic-only, minimal activity
Nasdaq 100 E-mini	Very limited	Memorial Day — electronic-only, minimal activity

Source: Investing.com pre-market data (Euro Stoxx 50 futures). DAX/CAC futures not confirmed at collection time. Verify at open.

4. YESTERDAY'S CLOSES — Friday 22 May 2026

INDEX	CLOSE	DAY CHANGE	DAY %	WEEK %
Euro Stoxx 50	6,019.45	+59.13	+0.99%	+3.00%
DAX	24,888.56	+283.4 est.	+1.15%	+3.92%
CAC 40	8,115.75	+30.0 est.	+0.37%	+2.05%
FTSE 100	10,466.26	+23.0 est.	+0.22%	+2.66%

Source: CNBC / Yahoo Finance. Intraday point changes estimated from % figures. Weekly data from T. Rowe Price.

5. US MARKETS — FRIDAY 22 MAY 2026

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE PTS	% CHANGE	STATUS
S&P 500	7,473.47	+27.5	+0.37%	8th consecutive weekly gain
Dow Jones	50,579.70	+294	+0.58%	ALL-TIME RECORD CLOSE
Nasdaq Comp.	26,343.97	+50.1	+0.19%	Slightly lagging

Session tone: Constructive into the long weekend. Easing 10Y yields (4.57%) and slightly lower oil provided the lift. Financials and industrials led; tech marginally lagged (Nasdaq underperforming Dow). Broad market breadth was positive. US markets closed Monday 25 May for Memorial Day; full session resumes Tuesday 26 May. The 8-week winning streak is the key statistic — sentiment is extended and a correction is overdue by historical standards.

6. ASIAN MARKETS — OVERNIGHT SESSION

May 25 Asian session data not confirmed at collection time. Last verified closes shown. Japan exported +14.8% YoY in April (semiconductor-driven), providing tailwind. Iran deal news positive for regional risk appetite.

INDEX	LAST CONFIRMED LEVEL	SESSION DATE	% CHANGE (THAT SESSION)	TONE / DRIVER
Nikkei 225	63,339.07	Fri 22 May	+2.68%	Strong; Japan export data beat; semiconductor surge
Hang Seng	25,606.03	Fri 22 May	n/a	Mixed; monitoring US-Iran developments
Shanghai Comp.	n/a	—	n/a	Not confirmed
Kospi	n/a	—	n/a	Not confirmed

Japan's export surge (+14.8% YoY in April, beating estimates) was the region's standout data point. Semiconductor shipments drove the outperformance. Nikkei's two-session 5.9% advance (May 21–22) reflects this fundamental backdrop. Asian markets overnight likely opened positive given the Dow record and Iran deal progress, but specific May 25 closing levels not sourced. Source: CNBC Asia (May 22 data).

7. COMMODITIES

COMMODITY	LEVEL (APPROX)	MOVE	CONTEXT
Brent Crude	~\$105.00/bbl	Elevated	Geopolitical premium intact; Hormuz closure risk. Formal deal = sharp downside.
WTI Crude	~\$98.00/bbl	Above \$98	Iran deal = \$15–25/bbl downside scenario. Key range: \$75–\$85 post-deal.
Gold	~\$4,500/oz	-0.4% (approx)	Second consecutive weekly decline. \$4,500 is key support. Hormuz resolution reduces safe-haven bid.
Natural Gas	\$2.92/MMBtu	-3.21%	Fell Friday on mild weather forecasts. Still +5.8% over one month. LNG export demand watch.
Copper	~\$6.20/lb	Retreating	Down from May 13 record of \$6.65/lb. Elevated energy costs squeezing manufacturing demand. Above \$6.00 support.

Oil is the key watch today. A formal Iran-Hormuz deal announcement could send Brent from \$105 to \$80–90 rapidly — a deflationary shock for energy markets but relief for European consumers and inflation-sensitive central banks. Gold at \$4,500 support: a break lower confirms geopolitical risk premium unwinding. Copper's pullback from record highs reflects the squeeze on manufacturing demand from high energy costs. Sources: BusinessUpturn (May 25 opening data), Trading Economics, Fortune.

8. RATES & FX

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	MOVE	NOTE
US 10Y Treasury	4.57%	Eased; -2 session slide	Stabilised post-CPI. Upside capped by sticky inflation surprise.
German 10Y Bund	3.04%	-6 bps Friday	Easing in tandem. US-EU spread stable ~153 bps.
EUR/USD	~1.1720	Falling	Rejected 1.18 resistance. Pressing toward 1.17 momentum pivot.
GBP/USD	~1.3450	Softer	Within 1.34–1.36 range. Bank holiday reduces GBP liquidity today.
DXY (Dollar Index)	~99.3	Rising	Near 6-week high. CPI beat + Fed-on-hold narrative supporting dollar.

Dollar strength is the dominant FX theme. EUR/USD rejection at 1.18 is technically significant — a break of 1.17 support would open 1.15. GBP is hobbled today by the bank holiday; thin liquidity exaggerates moves. A sudden Iran deal announcement could trigger a brief USD sell-off on risk-on flows but the structural case for dollar remains intact given CPI above expectations. Bund at 3.04% is watching ECB June decision closely. Sources: MarketPulse (OANDA), Trading Economics, CNBC.

9. DCM — PRIMARY BOND MARKET

YESTERDAY'S ISSUANCES — FRIDAY 22 MAY 2026

No confirmed deal data retrieved for Friday 22 May. Pre-holiday Friday sessions typically carry minimal European primary activity. The week of May 18–22 was broadly constructive for European IG issuance based on pipeline and sentiment data available. Specific deal terms not sourced.

PIPELINE / EXPECTED THIS WEEK

SEGMENT	DETAIL	TIMING
EU Supranational	€100bn H1 2026 program (6 syndications + 6 auctions). Next syndication TBA.	Ongoing; Tue window
EUR Corp IG	Pipeline building. M&A financing wave noted by market participants. 58% of surveyed participants expect issuance growth in 2026.	Tue–Thu active window
EUR HY / Crossover	<i>No specific mandates confirmed at collection time.</i>	<i>n/a</i>
EUR Financials / SSA	Covered bond and senior unsecured issuance ongoing. SSAs facing steeper yield curve — may shift to shorter maturities.	Tue–Thu window

KEY SPREADS

INDEX	LEVEL	MOVE	DIRECTION
iTraxx Main (5Y)	<i>n/a</i>	—	<i>Check Bloomberg/Refinitiv at open</i>
iTraxx Crossover (5Y)	<i>n/a</i>	—	<i>Check Bloomberg/Refinitiv at open</i>
CDX IG (5Y)	<i>n/a</i>	—	<i>US closed today — check Tuesday</i>
Avg EUR Corp IG Spread	<i>n/a</i>	—	<i>Not sourced at collection time</i>

COMMENTARY

Primary market tone heading into this week is constructive. Declining Bund yields and the European equity re-rating through the week of May 18–22 created a supportive backdrop for corporate issuers. With UK and US markets closed today, primary activity is effectively paused — Tuesday 26 May is the real open. If the Iran deal is formally announced, credit spreads should tighten materially, opening an attractive issuance window particularly for industrials, energy, and financials. The M&A pipeline noted by DCM survey respondents supports sustained HY and crossover supply through Q2. SSA issuers face steeper curves and are expected to pivot toward shorter maturities. Sources: GlobalCapital, Amundi Research, ICMA, European Commission issuance calendar.

10. ECONOMIC CALENDAR — 25 MAY 2026

UK Spring Bank Holiday + US Memorial Day: No UK or US macro releases today. Continental European markets open but no major scheduled data releases confirmed.

LONDON TIME	REGION	INDICATOR	CONSENSUS	IMPORTANCE
All day	UK	Spring Bank Holiday — markets closed, no releases	—	LOW
All day	US	Memorial Day — markets closed, no releases	—	LOW
—	Eurozone	No major scheduled releases (reduced calendar)	—	LOW

Week ahead from Tuesday 26 May: Watch for eurozone business confidence data (IFO, ESI), UK lending and mortgage approvals, US Conference Board Consumer Confidence, and JOLTS job openings. ECB speakers likely active ahead of June 5 rate decision. Full week schedule available Tuesday at market open. Sources: Trading Economics, LiteFinance week-ahead calendar.

11. CORPORATE EVENTS & EARNINGS

COMPANY / SEGMENT	REGION	EVENT	MARKET RELEVANCE
13 reports broadly (Yahoo Finance)	Mixed	Earnings — Monday 25 May	Thin slate; US closed; limited market impact today
CMB.TECH (CMBT.BR)	Belgium / Europe	Post-Q1 results (released 19 May)	Shipping sector; tanker rates; direct Hormuz exposure. Monitor Tuesday reaction.
Cadeler (CADLR.CO)	Denmark / Europe	Q1 2026 results (6-K filed)	Offshore wind installation; energy capex spending watch
Ferrovial (FER.MC)	Spain / Europe	Q1 2026 results (filed)	Infrastructure; Spanish large-cap; road and airport concessions

Peak earnings season has largely passed. Focus this week shifts to macro data and geopolitical events. Tuesday 26 May sees US earnings resume with 61 reports expected; Wednesday 27 May has 48 and Thursday 67. Sources: Yahoo Finance earnings calendar, SEC filings, Earnings Whispers.

12. STOCKS TO WATCH TODAY

Nokia (NOK1V.HE)	AI infrastructure order-flow surge drove +10.6% last week. Potential consolidation or momentum continuation. European tech sentiment leader in thin market — moves amplified today.	WATCH
ASML (ASML.AS)	Semiconductor equipment; +5% last week on AI capex cycle tailwind. Thin liquidity amplifies moves. Continuation watch above prior highs.	UP BIAS
Airbus (AIR.PA)	Aerospace re-rating on geopolitical de-escalation; +2%+ last week. Defense and civil backlog intact. Iran deal accelerates civil aviation recovery narrative.	UP BIAS
Santander (SAN.MC)	European banking leader; +2%+ last week. Rate environment supports NIM. Continental markets open today without UK competition. Spanish financials in focus.	UP BIAS
UniCredit (UCG.MI)	Paired with Santander in the European bank rally. Italian financial space benefiting from spread compression and M&A premium. Rate path supportive.	UP BIAS
Schneider Elec (SU.PA)	Data center and AI infrastructure play; +2%+ last week. Energy management and grid automation are structural growth themes. Momentum intact.	UP BIAS
TotalEnergies (TTE.PA)	Iran deal = major oil price downside risk. Brent near \$105 with \$15–25/bbl downside scenario on Hormuz reopening. Energy sector most exposed to deal announcement.	DOWN RISK
Shell (SHEL.L)	FTSE closed today (bank holiday). Key watch for Tuesday: Hormuz deal hits oil majors hardest. Positioning ahead of Tuesday open matters for this name.	DOWN RISK
CMB.TECH (CMBT.BR)	Shipping name directly exposed to Strait of Hormuz. Q1 results released May 19. Tanker and freight rates normalize sharply on deal — margin compression risk. Key sector bellwether.	KEY WATCH
Newmont (NEM)	Gold at \$4,500 under pressure (second weekly decline). Iran deal resolution reduces safe-haven demand. Break of \$4,500 gold = headwind for gold miners broadly.	DOWN RISK

13. MACRO / CORPORATE / POLITICAL HIGHLIGHTS

MACRO

US CPI 3.8% — inflation above target, Fed on hold

Headline CPI beat (3.8% vs 3.7% exp); core 2.8% vs 2.6% forecast. Fed cut timeline pushed further out. Dollar responds: DXY near 99.3 (6-week high). Market repricing June FOMC as live event. Kevin Warsh taking oath as new Fed Chair adds communication uncertainty.

S&P 500 — 8 consecutive weekly gains

Dow at record 50,580. S&P at 7,473. Risk appetite intact despite above-target inflation. Markets pricing Iran deal and growth recovery. 8-week streak is historically stretched; mean reversion risk rising.

Bund 3.04% / US 10Y 4.57% — rates easing modestly

German 10Y fell 6bps Friday to 3.04%. US 10Y stabilised at 4.57% after two sessions lower. US-EU spread ~153bps. EUR/USD pressing 1.17 support as dollar firms on sticky CPI.

CORPORATE

Nokia +10.6%, ASML +5% — European AI infrastructure re-rate

Nokia order-flow driven; ASML on sustained semiconductor capex cycle. European tech valuations converging with US peers. AI infrastructure is now a confirmed European equity theme, not just a US story.

CMB.TECH Q1 2026; shipping sector in Hormuz crosshairs

Tanker and bulk shipping rates elevated due to Middle East rerouting. A Hormuz deal normalises freight rates and compresses margins for operators including CMB.TECH. Cadeler (offshore wind) less affected but monitoring energy capex signals.

European equity re-rating — STOXX 600 at pre-war highs

Banks (Santander +2%+, UniCredit +2%+), industrials (Schneider +2%+, Airbus +2%+) all outperforming. Re-rating is macro and geopolitical-driven. Earnings follow-through needed to extend gains beyond current technical resistance.

POLITICAL / GEOPOLITICAL

Iran-US deal "largely negotiated" — two-phase structure

Phase 1: Strait of Hormuz reopening and immediate ceasefire. Phase 2 (30–60 days): nuclear enrichment provisions and permanent war termination. Deal could be announced within days per US officials. Rubio confirmed progress in talks. Sources: CNN, CNBC, Bloomberg, NPR (May 23–24).

Key sticking points remain — sovereignty over the Strait

Iran's Supreme Leader ordered enriched uranium to stay in-country. Iran's Fars agency disputed Trump's framing — demands permanent war end before nuclear talks. US and Iran still negotiating control structure over Hormuz. Gap between public statements and actual terms is wide.

Kevin Warsh takes oath as Fed Chair — communication risk

New Federal Reserve leadership introduces uncertainty around communication style and rate path signalling. Markets will parse any Warsh remarks this week closely for signals on June FOMC. Change of guard at the Fed is a latent volatility risk. Source: Schwab market commentary.

14. KEY THEMES — TOP 5 BY HORIZON

TODAY'S TOP 5

1. Iran deal headline risk

Deal announcement could hit wires any moment. Oil \$15–25/bbl downside; gold breaks \$4,500; equities rally sharply. Most impactful single event of the day.

2. Holiday liquidity trap

UK + US both closed. Continental Europe trades alone. Small orders create outsized moves. Gap risk on Euro Stoxx, DAX, and CAC elevated all session.

3. Gold at \$4,500 support

Critical technical and sentiment level. Break lower = risk premium unwind accelerating. Hold = safe-haven bid still active, deal not priced in.

4. Nokia / ASML — consolidate or extend

After last week's AI-driven 10.6% / 5% surges, direction in thin market sets the tone for European tech for the week.

5. Euro Stoxx futures gap vs spot

Futures imply lower open vs Friday 6,019 close. Whether this gap closes immediately or persists is the first market signal of the session.

THIS WEEK'S TOP 5

1. Iran deal Phase 1 formalization

Hormuz reopening agreement expected this week. Formal announcement = largest market-moving event of 2026 to date. Oil, shipping, defense, and FX all reprice.

2. US markets reopen Tuesday

Post-Memorial Day return brings full US liquidity. S&P at 7,473 after 8 up weeks — Tuesday open either extends or corrects. Direction-setting session for global risk.

3. Eurozone macro data

IFO, ESI, PMI data due. ECB June meeting in focus. Data shapes rate path expectations — cut or hold decision increasingly consequential for Bund and EUR/USD.

4. European primary bond market restart

DCM window opens Tuesday. Deal flow is a real-time proxy for credit market confidence. Watch for IG corporate, SSA, and financial issuance to gauge appetite.

5. Dollar vs EUR/USD at 1.17

DXY at 99.3 and EUR/USD pressing 1.17 support. This week's macro and geopolitical data determines whether the dollar rally extends or reverses at this key level.

THIS MONTH'S TOP 5

1. Iran-US peace framework — full deal

Phase 2 nuclear talks begin post-Hormuz deal. 30–60 day negotiation window. Full resolution = structural shift for energy, inflation, and EM. Most consequential geopolitical event for markets in 2026.

2. S&P 500 — 8-week streak vs correction

Sentiment is extended. A deal-driven oil collapse could trigger sharp sector rotation. Whether the S&P holds 7,400 is the technical key for the month.

3. ECB June 5 rate decision

Cut or hold — both scenarios have advocates given the data mix. Decision reshapes Bund yields and EUR/USD for the summer. ECB communication this week is key pre-positioning.

4. European equity rally ceiling

STOXX 600 at pre-Iran-war highs. Sustainability requires earnings follow-through and confirmed deal news. Without fundamental anchors, the technical resistance becomes a ceiling.

5. Oil price normalization shock

Hormuz reopening could collapse crude \$20–30/bbl from current levels. Deflationary for Europe — relief for consumers and ECB — but sector-level pain for energy, GCC credit, and petro-currencies.

15. KEY TRENDS TO WATCH

1 DAY

Iran deal headline is the #1 intraday catalyst — any formal announcement triggers immediate large moves across oil, gold, and equities. Thin liquidity (UK + US closed) amplifies all price action today; gap risk is elevated throughout the session. Euro Stoxx futures imply a cautious open below Friday's spot close. Watch Nokia and ASML for AI sentiment read in European tech. EUR/USD 1.17 is the critical FX level — a break opens 1.15 scenario rapidly.

1 WEEK

Full US market return Tuesday sets the weekly direction. Phase 1 Iran-Hormuz deal expected to be announced — oil, shipping, and defense names recalibrate across the week. Eurozone macro data (IFO, flash PMI) informs ECB June positioning; watch Bund yield reaction. European primary bond market reopens Tuesday — deal flow volume is a real-time proxy for credit confidence. Dollar path depends on the combined effect of sticky inflation data and geopolitical resolution; EUR/USD 1.17 support is the week's key FX level.

1 MONTH

Iran Phase 2 nuclear talks (30–60 days) define the macro backdrop for June. ECB June 5 rate decision is the most consequential near-term European event — cut or hold reshapes Bund yields and EUR/USD for summer. European equity rally sustainability: STOXX 600 at pre-war highs but without earnings acceleration, further upside is crowded and crowded trades are vulnerable to the first negative surprise. Oil normalization (\$80 vs \$105) is the biggest macro delta for European inflation, consumer spending, and credit markets. Fed path under Warsh leadership + sticky inflation = June FOMC the most watched US rates event through end of month.

Sources used this session: Reuters, CNN, CNBC, Bloomberg (via search aggregation), NPR, TheStreet, Motley Fool, Yahoo Finance, Trading Economics, BusinessUpturn (May 25 commodity opening data), MarketPulse by OANDA, T. Rowe Price weekly update, LiteFinance economic calendar preview, Investtech Morning Report (May 22), Schwab market commentary, GlobalCapital / ICMA (DCM context), Amundi Research (European bonds 2026), European Commission issuance calendar, SEC EDGAR (CMB.TECH, Cadeler, Ferrovial 6-K filings), Earnings Whispers, S&P Dow Jones Indices (iTraxx).

Data collected: 05:30–06:30 BST, Monday 25 May 2026. Data points marked "n/a" could not be reliably sourced during this session. iTraxx Main, Crossover, and CDX IG spread levels not confirmed — check Bloomberg/Refinitiv at European market open. Asian session May 25 closing data not available at collection time.

Data collected automatically. Verify all figures before making any investment or trading decision.